Part 1: Define Your Target User & Problem

Target Audience

The primary target audience for this product includes-

1. **Busy working professionals** who have limited time to plan and cook meals during weekdays.
2. **Fitness enthusiasts / gym-goers** who want to maintain a balanced diet and track nutritional intake such as calories, protein, carbs, and fats.
3. Individuals who want to **cook efficiently using ingredients already available at home** instead of spending time deciding what to cook.

These users value **time efficiency, healthy eating, and simplicity in meal planning**.

Also this app focuses only on the **Indian Dishes**.

Problem Statement

Busy professionals and fitness-conscious individuals often struggle to decide **what to cook within the limited time they have**, especially when trying to maintain a healthy diet. They frequently spend unnecessary time searching for recipes or planning meals, and gym enthusiasts find it difficult to track **nutritional intake (protein, carbs, fats, calories)** for each meal.

A smart meal planning tool can simplify this process by **suggesting recipes based on available ingredients, cooking time, and dietary preferences**, while also providing **nutritional insights for portion control and diet tracking**.

Key Problems the Product Should Solve -

1. Decision Fatigue in Meal Planning

Users often waste time deciding **what to cook with the ingredients they already have**. The product should recommend dishes instantly when users enter available ingredients and cooking time.

2. Lack of Personalized Meal Suggestions

Most recipe apps show generic recipes. Users need **personalized recommendations based on time availability, diet preferences, and pantry ingredients**.

3. Difficulty Tracking Nutritional Intake

Gym enthusiasts want to maintain specific **macronutrient goals (protein, carbs, fats, calories)**. The product should show **nutritional values per portion** so users can manage their diet effectively.

Part 2: Map Key User Flows

User Flow: Meal Planning for Busy Professionals & Gym Enthusiasts(Indian Dishes)

Goal: Help users quickly find meals based on available ingredients, cooking time, and nutritional needs.

Step-by-Step User Journey

1. **User opens the meal planning tool.**
2. **User selects their goal**

- Quick Meal Planning (Busy professionals)
- Nutrition-focused Meals (Gym enthusiasts)

3. **User enters available ingredients**

- Example: chicken, rice, spinach, eggs.

4. **User selects available cooking time**

- 15 minutes
- 30 minutes
- 45+ minutes

5. **User chooses dietary preference**

- High protein
- Low carb
- Vegetarian / Vegan
- Balanced diet

6. **System analyses inputs** and generates **recommended dishes**.
7. **User selects a dish** to view details:

- Recipe steps
- Cooking time
- Required ingredients
- Portion size

8. **System displays nutritional breakdown**

- Calories
- Protein
- Carbs
- Fats

9. **User adjusts portion size** to match their diet plan.
10. **User adds the meal to the weekly planner.**
11. **System updates weekly meal plan and nutrition summary.**

Outcome -

Users can quickly decide what to cook based on **ingredients and time**, while also tracking **nutritional intake** to maintain their diet goals.

Part 3- Building MealCraft

Prototype Overview

To address the problem of time-consuming meal planning, a simple and functional **meal planning prototype MealCraft was designed using Lovable**. The goal of the prototype is to help users quickly decide what to cook(Indian Dishes)based on **available ingredients, cooking time, and dietary preferences**, while also providing **nutritional information for each meal**.

The prototype focuses on making the experience **quick, intuitive, and useful for both busy professionals and fitness-conscious users**.

Easy to Use Interface

The prototype is designed with a **simple and intuitive interface** so that users can find meal suggestions in just a few steps. Also this is only for Indian Dishes.

Users only need to:

1. Enter ingredients available in their kitchen
2. Select the time they have to cook (15, 30, or 45 minutes)
3. Choose a dietary preference (high protein, vegetarian, balanced, etc.)

After entering these inputs, the system instantly generates **relevant recipe recommendations**. Each recipe card displays the **dish name, cooking time, and nutritional information**, along with an option to **add the meal to the weekly planner**.

This minimal interaction reduces decision fatigue and helps users quickly plan meals.

Reflective of Real-Life Routines

The design reflects how people normally decide what to cook in real life. Instead of searching through long recipe lists, users typically think about:

- What ingredients they already have at home
- How much time they have to cook

The prototype mirrors this natural decision-making process by allowing users to **start with available ingredients and time constraints**, making the experience practical and realistic for everyday use.

Additionally, the **weekly meal planner** allows users to organize meals for the week and make quick adjustments if needed.

Personalized for User Goals

The prototype personalizes meal suggestions based on **dietary preferences and nutritional needs**.

For example:

- Busy professionals can select **short cooking times** to get quick meal options.
- Gym enthusiasts can choose **high-protein meals** and view detailed nutrition information such as **protein, carbohydrates, fats, and calories**.

This ensures that meal recommendations align with the user's **lifestyle, health goals, and time constraints**.

Outcome

Overall, the prototype provides a **simple and personalized solution for weekly meal planning**, helping users reduce the time spent deciding what to cook while ensuring their meals align with their dietary needs.

Part 4 –Prototype Testing

To evaluate the usability of the meal planning tool, the prototype was tested with **three users** who fit the target audience:

- **User 1:** Working professional with limited time to cook
- **User 2:** Fitness enthusiast who tracks protein intake
- **User 3:** Student who cooks occasionally and prefers quick meals

They were asked to use the prototype to **find a meal using available ingredients and cooking time**.

Feedback Collected

What Worked Well

1. **Simple and clear interface**
   Users found the interface easy to understand and liked that they could quickly enter ingredients and get recipe suggestions.
2. **Time-based filtering**
   Busy users appreciated the ability to choose meals based on **available cooking time (15/30/45 minutes)**.
3. **Nutrition information**
   Gym users liked seeing **protein, carbs, fats, and calories** because it helped them evaluate whether the meal fits their diet goals.

What Didn't Work Well

1. **Recipe relevance**
   During testing, some recipe suggestions did not always match the ingredients entered

by the user. For example, when a user entered **chicken as an ingredient**, the system sometimes recommended dishes like **salmon bowls or tuna recipes**, which did not match the input. This made the recommendations feel less accurate.

2. **Limited guidance for new users**
   One user mentioned that it was not immediately clear **how many ingredients should be entered to get better recipe suggestions**.

What Was Confusing

Some users expected the app to **highlight which ingredients from their kitchen were used in the recommended recipes**. However, implementing this feature would require users to first **add and maintain a detailed list of all the ingredients available in their kitchen**.

This could make the process **more time-consuming and complex**, which goes against the core goal of the product—helping busy users quickly find meals based on a few inputs like ingredients and cooking time.

Since the primary target users are **busy professionals and fitness-focused individuals who value speed and simplicity**, the decision was made to keep the experience **minimal and fast**, allowing users to simply enter a few ingredients and instantly receive recipe suggestions.

Major Refinement Implemented

Ingredient-Based Recommendation Improvement

To improve the relevance of recipe suggestions, the recommendation logic was refined so that:

- Recipes must include **at least one main ingredient entered by the user**
- Recipes prioritize using **multiple ingredients from the user's input**
- Irrelevant recipes with completely different ingredients are excluded.

Additionally, the interface was updated to **highlight which user-provided ingredients are used in each recipe**.

Example:

Used ingredients: chicken, garlic, rice

This makes the recommendation system more transparent and useful for users.

Outcome

After the refinement, the prototype provided **more relevant meal suggestions**, making the experience more helpful for both **busy professionals looking for quick meals** and **gym enthusiasts tracking nutrition**.

Success Metrics –

To evaluate whether the product effectively solves the problem for **busy professionals and gym enthusiasts**, the following success metrics can be used.

1. Recipe Recommendation Conversion Rate

This measures how often users **select a suggested recipe after entering ingredients**.

Metric:
Percentage of users who click a recipe after receiving recommendations.

Why it matters:
If users frequently choose a recipe, it indicates that the **recommendations are relevant and useful**.

2. Meal Plan Completion Rate

This measures how many users successfully **add meals to the weekly planner**.

Metric:
Number of users who add at least one meal to their weekly plan.

Why it matters:
This indicates whether the product is helping users **actually plan their meals instead of just browsing recipes**.

3. Time Taken to Find a Recipe

Since the target users are **busy professionals**, the product should help them decide quickly.

Metric:
Average time taken from entering ingredients to selecting a recipe.

Why it matters:
If users can find a recipe within **30–60 seconds**, the tool is effectively reducing decision-making time.

4. Nutrition Feature Usage

This measures whether **gym enthusiasts are using the nutritional information**.

Metric:
Percentage of users who view or interact with **nutrition details (protein, carbs, fats, calories)**.

Why it matters:
High usage indicates that the feature is valuable for **fitness-focused users**.

5. User Retention

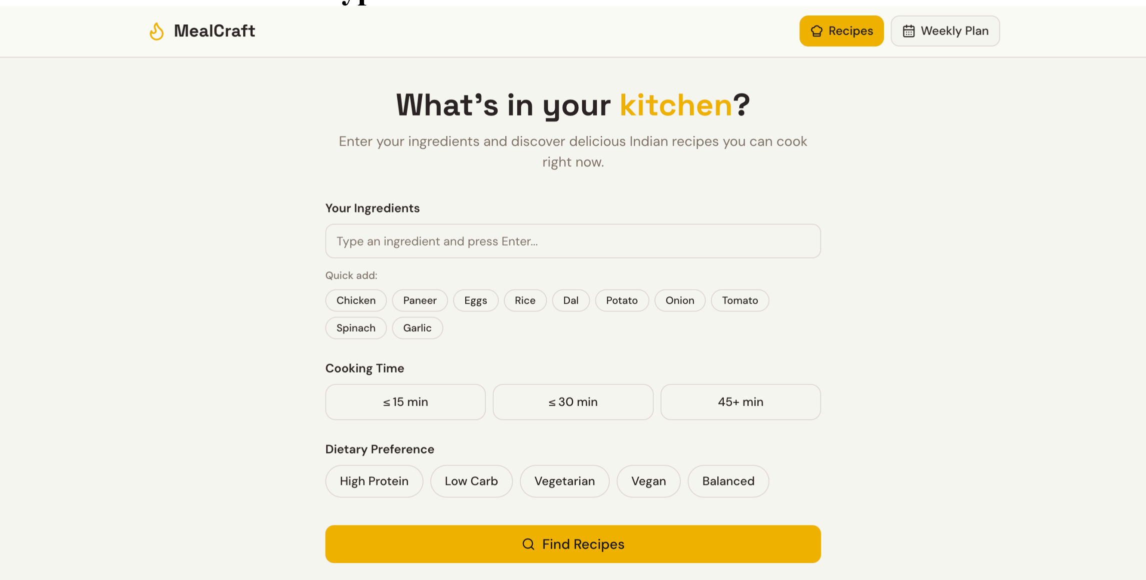
This measures whether users return to the app for meal planning.

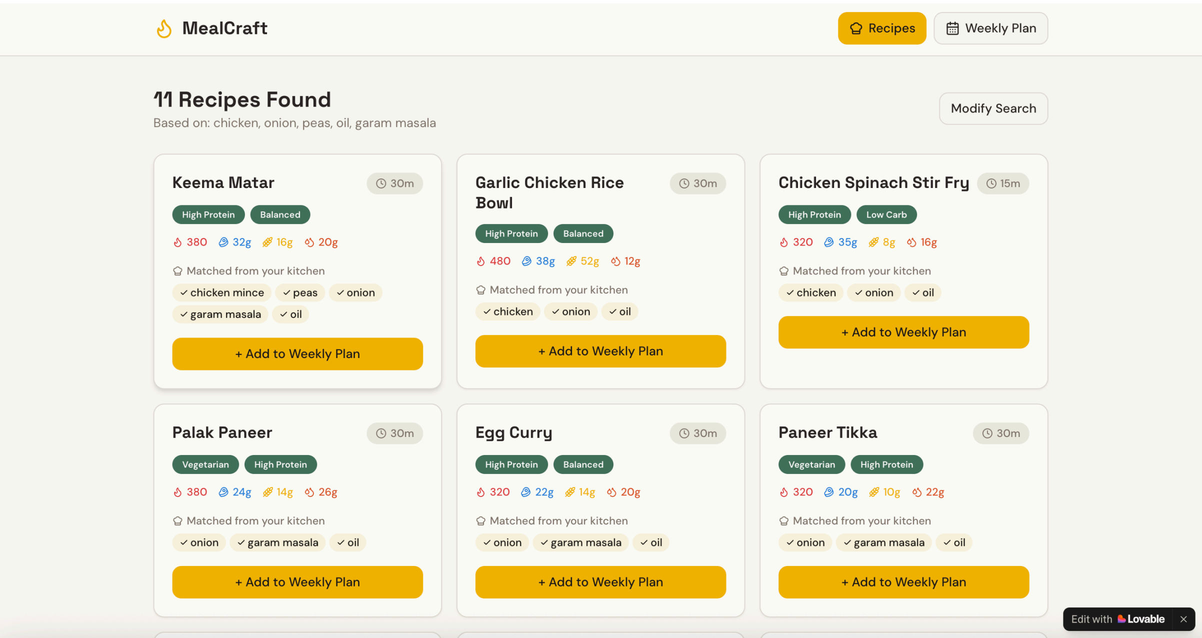
Metric:
Percentage of users who return to the app within **a week**.

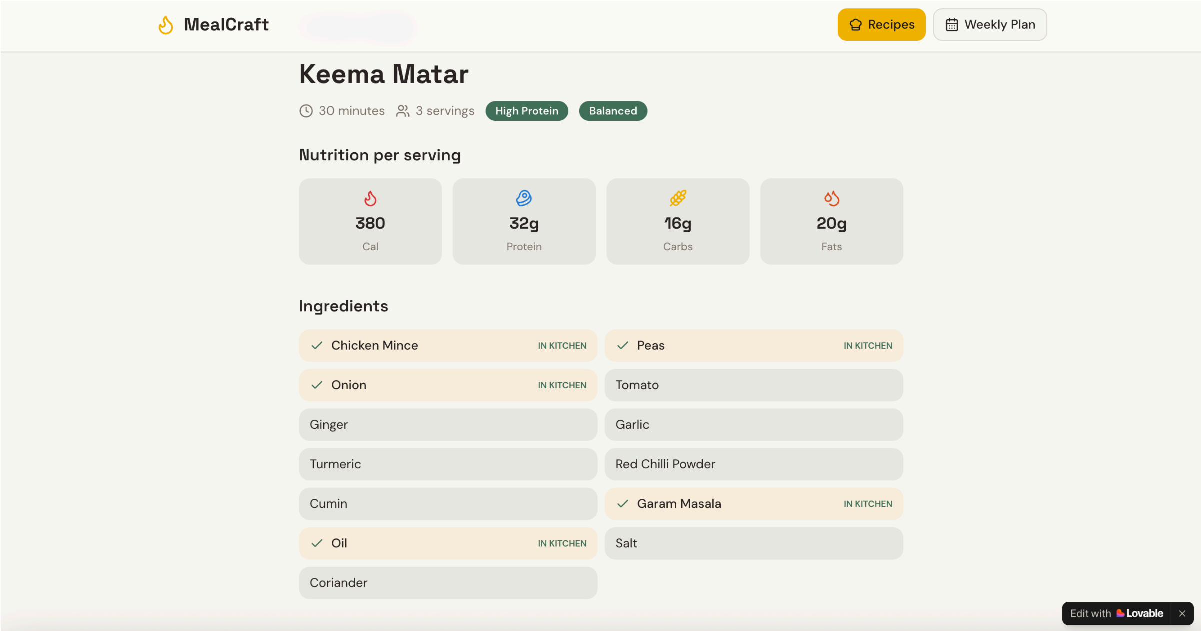
Why it matters:
If users repeatedly use the tool, it suggests that the product has become part of their **weekly meal planning routine**.

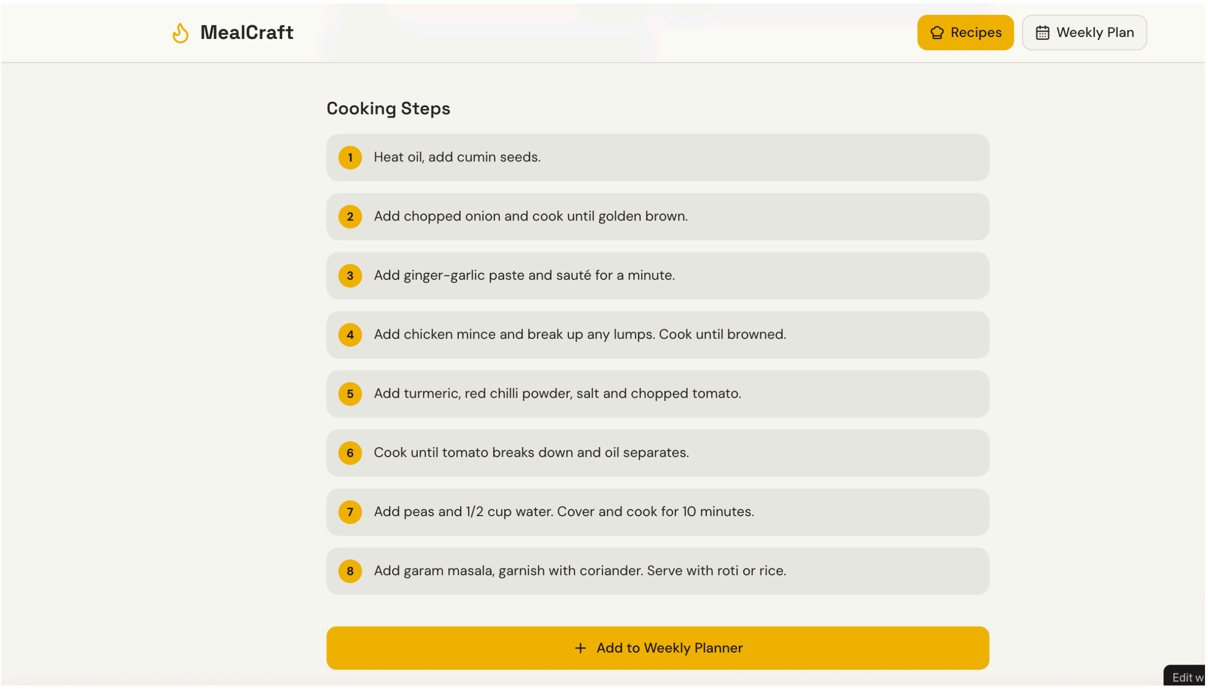
Lovable Prototype Link-https://indian-spice-planner.lovable.app/

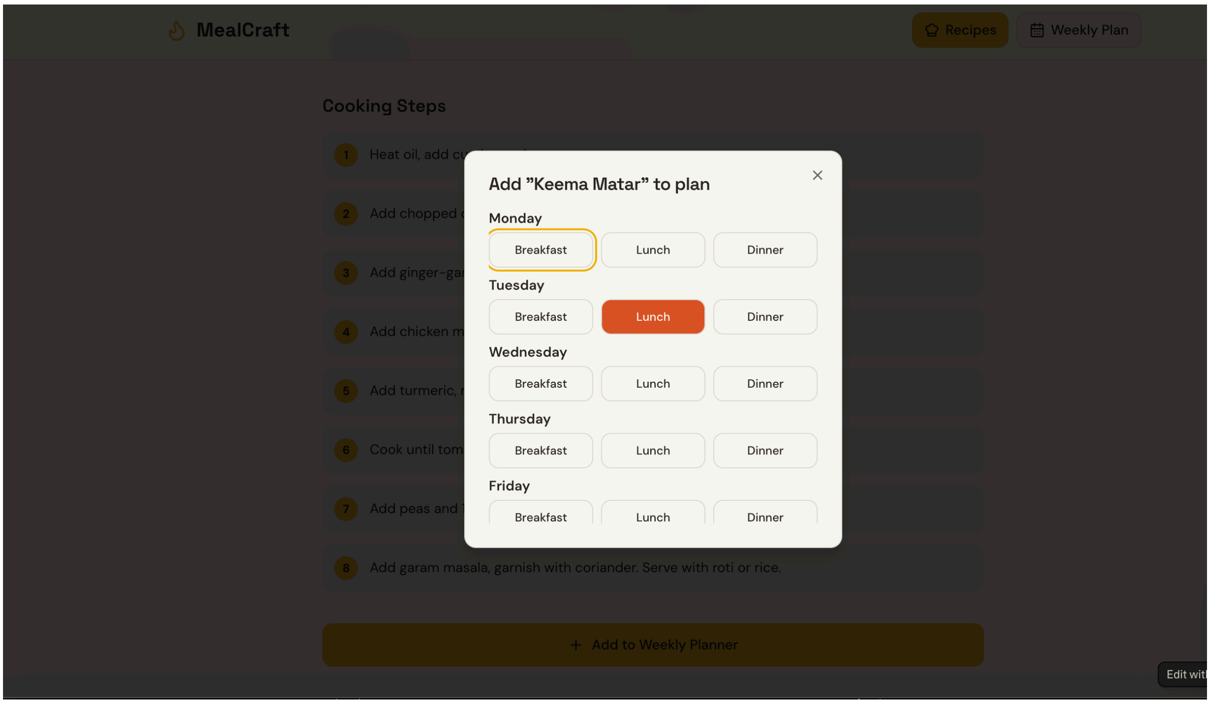
Screenshots of the Prototype-

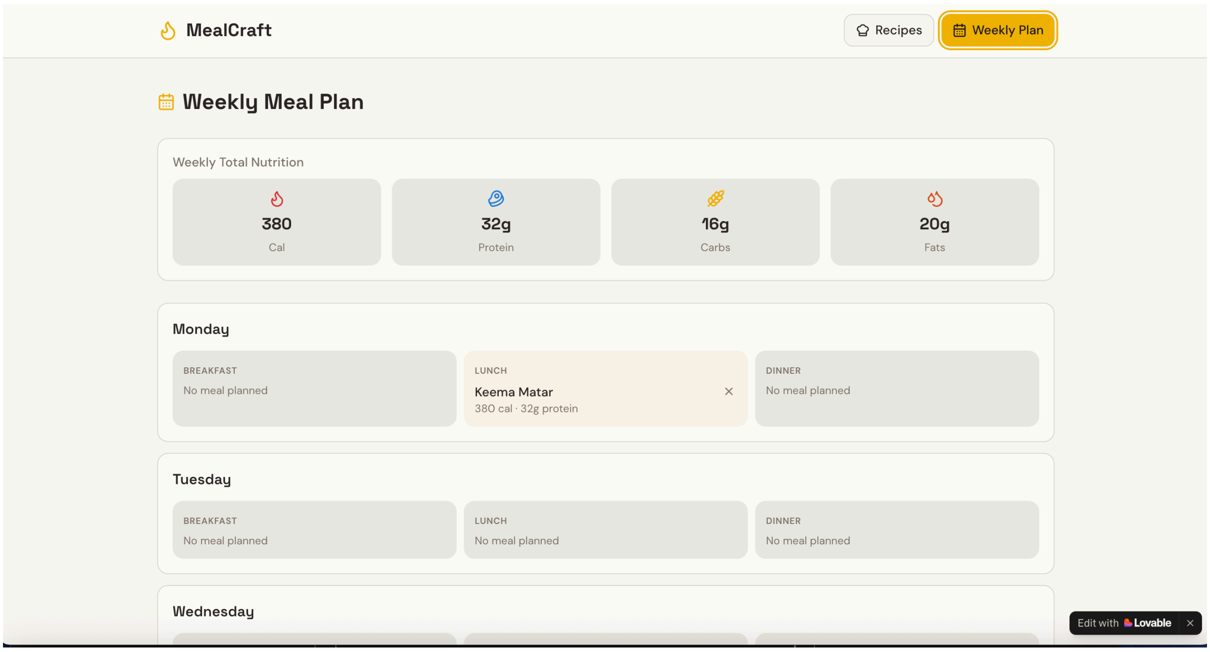





MealCraft
Recipes
Weekly Plan
Keema Matar
30 minutes
3 servings
High Protein
Balanced
Nutrition per serving
380
Cal
32g
Protein
16g
Carbs
20g
Fats
Ingredients
Chicken Mince
IN KITCHEN
Peas
IN KITCHEN
Onion
IN KITCHEN
Tomato
Ginger
Garlic
Turmeric
Red Chilli Powder
Cumin
Garam Masala
IN KITCHEN
Oil
IN KITCHEN
Salt
Coriander
Edit with Lovable


MealCraft
Recipes
Weekly Plan
Cooking Steps
1 Heat oil, add cumin seeds.
2 Add chopped onion and cook until golden brown.
3 Add ginger-garlic paste and sauté for a minute.
4 Add chicken mince and break up any lumps. Cook until browned.
5 Add turmeric, red chilli powder, salt and chopped tomato.
6 Cook until tomato breaks down and oil separates.
7 Add peas and 1/2 cup water. Cover and cook for 10 minutes.
8 Add garam masala, garnish with coriander. Serve with roti or rice.
+ Add to Weekly Planner


MealCraft
Recipes
Weekly Plan
Cooking Steps
Add "Keema Matar" to plan
Monday
Breakfast
Lunch
Dinner
Tuesday
Breakfast
Lunch
Dinner
Wednesday
Breakfast
Lunch
Dinner
Thursday
Breakfast
Lunch
Dinner
Friday
Breakfast
Lunch
Dinner
Add garam masala, garnish with coriander. Serve with roti or rice.
Add to Weekly Planner


MealCraft
Recipes
Weekly Plan
Weekly Meal Plan
Weekly Total Nutrition
380
Cal
32g
Protein
16g
Carbs
20g
Fats
Monday
BREAKFAST
No meal planned
LUNCH
Keema Matar
380 cal · 32g protein
DINNER
No meal planned
Tuesday
BREAKFAST
No meal planned
LUNCH
No meal planned
DINNER
No meal planned
Wednesday
Edit with Lovable